

BETA-READING REPORT

The manuscript's strongest quality is emotional restraint.

The characters do not explain everything immediately, which creates room for the reader to interpret their silences.

Strengths

Character Relationships

Sophie and Daniel have obvious unresolved history.

The manuscript should continue allowing that tension to develop naturally.

Emotional Conflict

The father's death creates an excellent reason for the characters to confront their shared past.

Mystery

The question of why Sophie left gives the contemporary story a subtle mystery element without changing its literary tone.

Suggested Improvements

The middle chapters should avoid relying entirely on the mystery.

Give Sophie a present-day life outside Daniel.

Show what she has built during the eleven years.

Then contrast that life with what she left behind.

Final Recommendation

Recommend continuing development.

The story has strong emotional potential and could appeal to readers who enjoy family secrets, complicated relationships, memory, regret, and second chances.

Beta-reader rating: 8.6/10